

12 Reported speech

In Level 2, we learnt about using **reported speech** to report what has been said or asked. (See Appendix 3 for a summary of how to change a statement or a question into reported speech.) In this unit you will practise changing direct **orders, requests, offers, suggestions**, etc. into **reported speech**.

12.1 Reported orders and requests

We can use the structure

ask/command/instruct/order/request/tell + **noun/pronoun** + *to-infinitive* to report an order or request.



Helen **asked Paul to tell** his brother about the birthday party.



The policeman **instructed the driver to stop** and **get out of** the car.

Note

Pronouns, possessive adjectives (*my, our, your*, etc.) and the adverbs/adverbial phrases of time and place (*now, this morning, here, in this house*, etc.) change in the same way as in **reported statements**.



Kathy asked her mum to wake **her** up at five **the next morning**.

12.2 Reported offers, suggestions, etc.

We use the reporting verbs *offer*, *advise*, *suggest*, etc. to report an offer, advice, a suggestion, etc. The following table shows some of these reporting verbs.

reported offers, refusals and agreements	agree, invite, offer, promise, refuse
reported advice and suggestions	advise, caution, recommend, remind, suggest, warn

We use these verbs in the following structures:

- offer*, *promise*, *agree*, *refuse*, etc. + **to-infinitive**



Let me **drive** you home.

Ken **offered to drive** Abby home.

- remind*, *warn*, *advise*, *invite*, etc. + **noun/pronoun** + **to-infinitive**

The doctor **advised Sally to get** plenty of rest and **drink** lots of water.

You should **get** plenty of rest and **drink** lots of water.



- suggest*, *recommend*, *advise*, etc. + **gerund**



Let's **go** for a swim.

Lily **suggested going** for a swim.

Compare: Lily suggested (that) *we go* for a swim.



Note

We put **not** before the *to*-infinitive or the gerund to form the negative.

Mr Chan told his students **not to walk** on the grass.

Eddie suggested **not going** to Macau at this time of year.

PRACTICE

A Read what the following people said yesterday and then fill in each blank with a suitable reporting verb.

- 1 Ken to his friend: 'I'll carry your luggage.'

Ken offered to carry his friend's luggage.

- 2 Mr Chan: 'Let's take a break.'

Mr Chan suggested taking a break.

- 3 Tommy: 'I won't tell Susan about it.'

Tommy promised not to tell Susan about it.

- 4 Lily to Peter: 'I won't let you use my phone.'

Lily refused to let Peter use her phone.

- 5 Mrs Cheung to her daughter: 'Don't open the door to strangers.'

Mrs Cheung warned/cautioned/advised her daughter not to open the door to strangers.

- 6 Mrs Wong to her son: 'Get down from that tree.'

Mrs Wong told/ordered/
commanded/instructed her son to get down from the tree.

- 7 Maggie to Louis: 'Come and have lunch with us today.'

Maggie invited/asked Louis to have lunch with them that day.

- 8 Mrs Lee to her son: 'Don't forget to buy some fruit and vegetables on your way home.'

Mrs Lee reminded her son to buy some fruit and vegetables on his way home.

- 9 Helen to her husband: 'You'd better book a table early.'

Helen advised her husband to book a table early.

(accept all reasonable answers)

B Underline the mistakes in the following sentences and write the correct word or words/phrases in the space on the right. If a word/phrase needs to be added, put a caret (^) in the correct place and write the correct word/phrase in the space. If there is no mistake, put a tick (✓) in the space. The first three have been done for you as examples.

- 1 Pat advised me taking the cookery course.

to take

- 2 The taxi driver offered ^ carry our luggage to the door.

to

- 3 Ann asked the hotel receptionist for a wake-up call at 7 am.

✓

- 4 My brother reminded me buying some food for our dog.

to buy

- | | | |
|----|--|---|
| 5 | Cindy asked me <u>did not tell</u> anybody her address. | <u>not to tell</u> |
| 6 | Carol suggested taking a bus instead of the MTR. | <u>✓</u> |
| 7 | I don't know why John refused <u>considering</u> our offer. | <u>to consider</u> |
| 8 | Grace invited us to visit her new home in Tung Chung. | <u>✓</u> |
| 9 | Brian promised <u>Λ</u> would not be late for the meeting. | <u>Q9 other possible answer</u>
<u>he</u> |
| 10 | Brenda told her friends not <u>Λ</u> smoke in her flat. | <u>Brian promised ^{not to} would not be late for the meeting.</u>
<u>to</u> |
| 11 | Who recommended that you watch this film? | <u>✓</u> |
| 12 | 'I'm here to see Mr Patrick Ho,' Johnny <u>told</u> to the receptionist. | <u>said</u> |

C Rewrite as **reported speech** what the people in the pictures are saying. The first one has been done for you as an example.

- | | | |
|---|---|--|
| 1 |  It rained heavily yesterday | John's mother said <u>(that) it had rained heavily the day before/the previous day</u> . |
| 2 |  What will you do this Sunday, Lea? | Mr Chan asked Lea <u>what she would do that Sunday</u> . |
| 3 |  Please turn off the television for me, Joe. | Joe's grandma <u>asked him to turn off the television for her</u> . |
| 4 |  Stop writing now, class. | The teacher <u>told the/her class to stop writing then</u> . |
| 5 |  We will talk about the meeting tomorrow. | Mrs Wong said <u>(that) they would talk about the meeting the next day</u> . |
| 6 |  Don't eat too much chocolate, Alan. | Janet <u>advised/warned/told Alan not to eat too much chocolate</u> . |
| 7 |  Where did you put the keys, Grace? | Miss Leung <u>asked Grace where she had put the keys</u> . |

8



Don't skip your breakfast, Matt.

Matt's father told/warned/advised his son/Matt not
to skip his breakfast.

9



Do you know how to get to the herbal tea shop, Kate?

Peggy asked Kate if she knew how to get to the
herbal tea shop.

(accept all reasonable answers)

D Complete the following newspaper article by underlining the correct options given in brackets.

Consumer complaints against beauty salons, gyms and yoga studios have increased by 30 per cent over the past year, according to consumer watchdog HK Consumers. Some of these complaints involved dishonest or improper sales tactics. In one case, a member of staff from a beauty salon told a customer ⁽¹⁾ (hand over / to hand over) her credit card in the middle of a beauty treatment and then asked her ⁽²⁾ (to purchase / purchasing) expensive treatment packages. In another case, an instructor at a yoga studio pretended to give customers advice and then suggested that they ⁽³⁾ (signing up / sign up) for expensive service contracts. One of the customers, a man in his 60s, told reporters that he ⁽⁴⁾ (had signed up / signed up) for a contract that cost him a total of \$200 000. He said that the charges ⁽⁵⁾ (took up / take up) most of his retirement savings. He added that he ⁽⁶⁾ (reported / had reported) the case to the police, and that he ⁽⁷⁾ (would do / shall do) all he could to obtain a full refund.

Some complaints involved poor service. A woman complained that she ⁽⁸⁾ (had only received / only received) four treatments at a beauty salon in a year even though her contract promised ten treatments during that period. A man complained that he ⁽⁹⁾ (was paying / had paid) a lot for a gym membership but was soon disappointed by the poor equipment and maintenance of the gym.

HK Consumers advised consumers ⁽¹⁰⁾ (to be careful / should be careful) when they sign up for services provided by beauty salons, gyms and yoga studios. It recommended ⁽¹¹⁾ (looking up / look up) information online about the companies involved and the plans they offer before handing over any money. It also warned them ⁽¹²⁾ (don't sign up / not to sign up) for prepaid plans with a distant expiry date. The watchdog said they ⁽¹³⁾ (had put up / were put up) a list of dishonest beauty salons, gyms and yoga studios on their website and ⁽¹⁴⁾ (shall help / would help) consumers make wiser choices when contacted.

E Read the following conversation and complete the diary entry below using **reported speech**.

- Paul** What's wrong with Pinky? She hasn't been able to walk properly for days.
- Vet** Let me see ... she doesn't seem to have a sprained knee.
- Paul** Does she have a broken leg?
- Vet** I don't think so. She seems to be able to support herself on all four legs. It's more likely that she has problems with her leg muscles.
- Paul** What kind of problems does she have?
- Vet** It can be an inflammation, or she could have pulled a muscle or two.
- Paul** What can we do now?
- Vet** For the time being, don't take her on long walks. When you're at home, don't let her jump onto beds or sofas. I'll give her some medications. If she still can't walk properly in two weeks, then you'll have to bring her back for an x-ray.

12 May Friday

This morning I took Pinky to the vet. I told the vet that she ⁽¹⁾ had not been able to walk properly
for days. He carried out a check on her and said she ⁽²⁾ did not seem to have a
sprained knee. I asked him ⁽³⁾ if/whether she had a broken leg.
 He answered that ⁽⁴⁾ he did not think so because she ⁽⁵⁾ seemed to be able to support
herself on all four legs. He thought it ⁽⁶⁾ was more likely that she had problems with
her leg muscles. I wondered ⁽⁷⁾ what kind of problems she had.
 The vet told me ⁽⁸⁾ it could be an inflammation, or she could have pulled a muscle or
 two. I asked him ⁽⁹⁾ what we could do. He told me ⁽¹⁰⁾ not to take her on long walks
for the time being, and advised me ⁽¹¹⁾ not to let her jump onto beds or sofas
. He gave her some medications and asked me ⁽¹²⁾ to take her back for an x-ray
if she did not get better in two weeks.

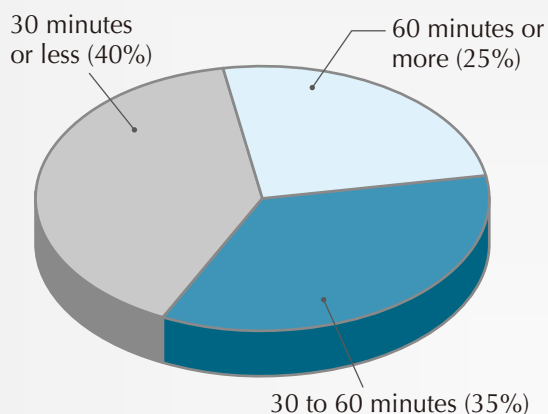
(accept all reasonable answers)

F Your school's Sports Club has done a survey on students' health. As a representative of the club, you have been asked to write a report on the findings of the survey. Complete the missing parts in the excerpt from the report using the information given. Use **reported speech**.

Sports Club Survey: How healthy are you?

1 How many minutes do you exercise every day?

Survey results:



Responses from students:

'I'd rather play video games than do exercise. It's more fun!'

'I love ball games. I play basketball with my friends after school every day.'

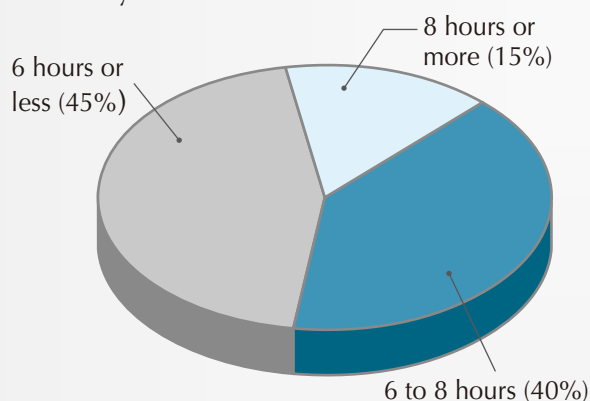
'I think sleeping is more important than doing exercise!'

Advice from the school's social worker, Miss C.L. Chan:

'I would say doing 20 minutes of exercise a day can do students a lot of good.'

2 How many hours do you sleep every night?

Survey results:



Responses from students:

'I usually get enough hours of sleep except when I need to study for exams.'

'Would it help if I took a nap during lunchtime?'

Advice from the school's social worker, Miss C.L. Chan:

'Students should get at least 6 hours of sleep every night. Without sufficient sleep, they may not be able to concentrate during classes and exams, and this could affect their exam results. As for napping, a nap during lunchtime might help them refresh themselves for the afternoon, but it cannot make up for lack of sleep at night.'

Sports Club Survey: How healthy are you?

Report

Introduction

Sports Club conducted a survey titled 'How healthy are you?' last month. Over 500 students were interviewed. The purpose of the survey was to find out students' habits related to health. This report discusses the findings and recommendations that resulted from the survey.

Findings

We asked students five questions. In the first question, we asked students ⁽¹⁾ how many minutes they exercised every day. Around 40% of students spent 30 minutes or less exercising. Some told us that they ⁽²⁾ preferred playing video games to doing exercise because it was more fun. Some thought that sleeping ⁽³⁾ was more important than doing exercise.

Around 35% of students exercised 30 to 60 minutes a day while the remaining 25% spent more than an hour on physical activities every day. A student said she ⁽⁴⁾ loved ball games and ⁽⁵⁾ played basketball with her friends after school every day. Miss C.L. Chan, the school's social worker, suggested that ⁽⁶⁾ students do 20 minutes of exercise a day because it could do them a lot of good.

We also asked students ⁽⁷⁾ how many hours they slept every night. We found that quite a lot of students do not get enough sleep. About 45% of students slept six hours or less a night. A student said he slept less when ⁽⁸⁾ he needed to study for exams. Another student asked ⁽⁹⁾ if taking a nap during lunchtime would help.

Miss Chan recommended that ⁽¹⁰⁾ students get at least 6 hours of sleep every night. She cautioned students that without sufficient sleep, ⁽¹¹⁾ they might/may not be able to concentrate during classes and exams, and that could affect their exam results. She added that while a lunchtime nap might help students refresh themselves for the afternoon, ⁽¹²⁾ it could not make up for lack of sleep at night.

(accept all reasonable answers)

USING THE LANGUAGE

In addition to reported statements and questions, we can also use **reported speech** when talking about orders, requests and suggestions. We can use it in, for example, a news report to recount what happened during an incident. We can also use it in an email to summarize a conversation and share advice. Look at the examples below. Note the uses of **reported speech** in bold.

News report (excerpt)

Several police officers **persuaded the Nepalese man to step back from the edge of the building but the man refused to listen**. In the nick of time, a Nepalese police officer spoke to him in their native language. He **advised the man to think carefully before leaping from the building and promised to help the best they could**. Finally, the man **agreed to come down**.

Email (excerpt)

The school's career **advisor asked me what I wanted to do in the future**. I answered that **I don't really know!** Then she surprised me by saying that was okay because we are only in Secondary 3, but then she **advised me to start thinking about what I like doing best**. She also **suggested doing some personality tests and attending the upcoming careers talk**.

-  Your teacher asks you to write an email to a friend about a recent meeting with a successful person, and the advice they gave you, to practise using **reported speech**. Begin with the given words. Do not write more than 140 words.

Hey Pam

I've just met the most interesting **the artist Julia Chow, who is my friend's aunt**. I was so excited. I announced that I loved her paintings and she replied that she was touched. I asked her how I could become a successful artist like her, and she told me to believe in my dreams and keep trying. As I was still young, she suggested studying art abroad to refine my techniques and broaden my horizons. She also reminded me repeatedly about the importance of developing one's own style. Next, she advised me to set up a web page and put images of all my paintings online. She said this would let more people discover my work. You can't imagine how nice she was. She even invited me to see her latest exhibition and promised to introduce me to her artist friends.

Cheers

Chris

(accept any reasonable answer)